



AGENDA FOR THE WORLD I&B Secretary Apurva Chandra says this year's G20 communiqué will have the stamp of India

regarding the anti-corruption measures of the G20 nations. And there also the Prime Minister said that information sharing is very essential. It is a very important point. I am sure more would be deliberated during the summit.

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One of the features of India's G20 presidency has been this focus on taking delegates from member nations across India, getting them to experience first-hand the vibrancy and diversity of our country. How did this idea come about?

This has been one of the biggest achievements of this G20. They [the delegates] have been wondering about the diversity,

the cuisine, the artefacts, the handicrafts and textiles [of India]. Apart from that, the people themselves—because various parts of the country have different cultures, speak different languages. It is the unity of India that we have showcased in a beautiful way to the world. I have visited 23 locations. Take for example Srinagar, where the delegates saw the way the situation has changed for the better in Jammu & Kashmir. Then again in Siliguri—where some ambassadors were so enchanted by the beauty of that place that they said they would like to come back again. So, I think it does make a difference in terms of tourism, awareness about

the country, its culture and so many other things. Everywhere, the people have welcomed the G20 and that again shows the unity of our country.

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Would you agree that India has set a new benchmark for other G20 countries?

I think it is a very, very high benchmark that has been set... It will become the gold standard.

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Do you think this year-long push has led to better awareness about India as an investment destination?

It is [thanks to the] efforts of the past nine years of this government that

Make in India has taken off. It is not just a one-year thing, but yes, in terms of showcasing, the G20 has helped because the changes don't come overnight. In fact, I was the Principal Secretary, Industries, in Maharashtra in 2014, when the government took over, and one of the first big conferences that PM Modi addressed was for the launch of the Make in India programme. And the results are for everyone to see. The G20 has definitely helped because everywhere, wherever the meetings were held, there were also side events that showcased Make in India to the delegates as well as the foreign media. **BT**

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